

1 ENGROSSED HOUSE  
2 BILL NO. 4302

By: Norwood of the House

3 and

4 Gillespie of the Senate

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6  
7 An Act relating to children; amending 10 O.S. 2021,  
8 Section 601.6, as amended by Section 1, Chapter 178,  
9 O.S.L. 2025 (10 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 601.6),  
10 which relates to the Office of Juvenile System  
11 Oversight; authorizing the release of certain  
12 information for certain purposes; prohibiting  
13 disclosure to any other person or entity; providing  
14 exception; and providing an effective date.

15 BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

16 SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 10 O.S. 2021, Section 601.6, as  
17 amended by Section 1, Chapter 178, O.S.L. 2025 (10 O.S. Supp. 2025,  
18 Section 601.6), is amended to read as follows:

19 Section 601.6. A. For purposes of this section, the term  
20 "children and youth service system" shall have the same meaning as  
21 it is defined in Section 600 of this title.

22 B. The Office of Juvenile System Oversight shall have the  
23 responsibility of inspecting and investigating misfeasance and  
24 malfeasance within the children and youth service system, as

1 directed by the Oklahoma Commission on Children and Youth, to  
2 ascertain compliance with established responsibilities.

3 C. The Office shall conduct not less than one but not more than  
4 two regular, periodic, unannounced inspections of state-operated  
5 children's institutions and facilities annually. The Office is  
6 further authorized to inspect privately operated children's  
7 institutions and facilities that receive state or federal funding,  
8 on a periodic basis or as needed.

9 D. The Office shall investigate complaints filed with the  
10 Office regarding the children and youth service system.

11 E. The Office of Juvenile System Oversight shall have the  
12 authority to:

13 1. Access all facilities within the children and youth service  
14 system for the purpose of conducting inspections and investigations;

15 2. Examine and copy all records and budgets pertaining to the  
16 children and youth service system and to review inspection reports  
17 of the State Fire Marshal, State Department of Health, and any other  
18 agency that accredits such institutions and facilities;

19 3. Interview the residents of institutions and facilities  
20 within the children and youth service system;

21 4. Subpoena witnesses and hold public hearings;

22 5. Establish, in accordance with the Dispute Resolution Act,  
23 Sections 1801 through 1813 of Title 12 of the Oklahoma Statutes, a  
24 voluntary program for foster parents to mediate complaints

1 concerning the rights of foster parents, as provided for in Section  
2 1-9-119 of Title 10A of the Oklahoma Statutes, that relate to  
3 certain actions, inactions or decisions of the Department of Human  
4 Services, the Department of Juvenile Justice, or child-placing  
5 agencies that may adversely affect the safety and well-being of  
6 children in the custody of the state;

7 6. Receive any complaint alleging that an employee of the  
8 Department of Human Services or a child-placing agency has  
9 threatened a foster parent with removal of a child from the foster  
10 parent, harassed a foster parent, or refused to place a child in a  
11 licensed or certified foster home, or disrupted a child placement as  
12 retaliation or discrimination towards a foster parent who has:

- 13 a. filed a grievance pursuant to Section 1-9-120 of Title  
14 10A of the Oklahoma Statutes,
- 15 b. provided information to any state official or  
16 Department employee, or
- 17 c. testified, assisted, or otherwise participated in an  
18 investigation, proceeding, or hearing against the  
19 Department or child-placing agency.

20 The Office of Juvenile System Oversight shall forward the  
21 complaints to the Office of Client Advocacy for investigation  
22 pursuant to subsection D of Section 1-9-112 of Title 10A of the  
23 Oklahoma Statutes. The Office of Juvenile System Oversight shall  
24 work with the Office of Client Advocacy to ensure the complaints are

1 investigated and resolved in accordance with the grievance  
2 procedures provided in Section 1-9-120 of Title 10A of the Oklahoma  
3 Statutes. The provisions of this paragraph shall not apply to any  
4 complaint by a foster parent regarding the result of a criminal,  
5 administrative, or civil proceeding for a violation of any law,  
6 rule, or contract provision by that foster parent, or the action  
7 taken by the Department or a child-placing agency in conformity with  
8 the result of any such proceeding;

9 7. Issue reports to the Governor, Speaker of the House of  
10 Representatives, President Pro Tempore of the Senate, Chief Justice  
11 of the Supreme Court of the State of Oklahoma, any appropriate  
12 prosecutorial agency, the director of the agency under  
13 consideration, and other persons as necessary and appropriate; and

14 8. Provide recommendations to the Oklahoma Commission on  
15 Children and Youth on or before May 1 of each year.

16 F. The Office of Juvenile System Oversight shall not release  
17 information that would identify a person who makes a complaint to  
18 the Office, unless a:

19 1. A court of competent jurisdiction orders release of the  
20 information for good cause shown; or

21 2. The disclosure of such information is made to an appropriate  
22 law enforcement agency when necessary to protect the safety of  
23 others after a complainant communicates an imminent and credible  
24 threat against an individual or entity that a reasonable person

1 would interpret as a serious expression of intent to commit an act  
2 of unlawful violence. Such information shall not be disclosed to  
3 any other person or entity except pursuant to an order of a court of  
4 competent jurisdiction.

5 SECTION 2. This act shall become effective November 1, 2026.

6 Passed the House of Representatives the 23rd day of March, 2026.

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9 Presiding Officer of the House  
of Representatives

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11 Passed the Senate the \_\_\_\_ day of \_\_\_\_\_, 2026.

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14 Presiding Officer of the Senate  
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